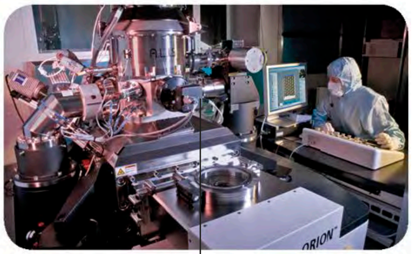
Airship

This airship *contains large quantities of helium to make itself lighter than air.*

Party balloon

This balloon *contains a mixture of helium and air.*

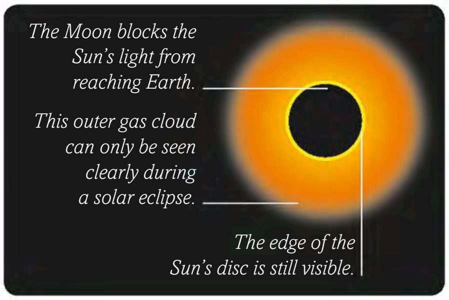
Helium-ion microscope



This powerful microscope *can zoom in to view much smaller details than most other microscopes.*

SUN GAS

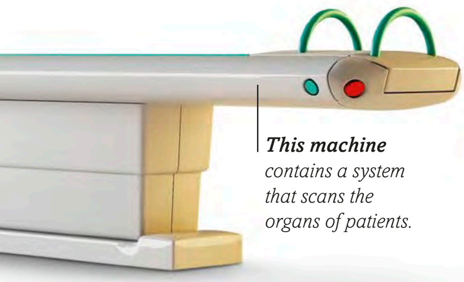
In 1868, during a total solar eclipse (when the Moon passes directly in front of the Sun), helium was discovered in the cloud of gas seen around the Sun. The yellow colour of this cloud showed it contained an unknown gas, which was named after Helios, the Greek god of the Sun.



This high-speed train *uses a pair of magnets: one to move forward and one to float over the track.*

The track is lined with a magnet *that repels the one on the train, making it float.*

Helium-cooled maglev train



This machine *contains a system that scans the organs of patients.*

Helium has the **lowest melting point** of any element.

Rocket helium tank

Helium in this container *will fill up a rocket's fuel tanks as they empty out during liftoff.*

collected from underground reservoirs or is found mixed in natural **gas** and oil. Unlike hydrogen, which is very reactive, helium is a noble gas and does not react at all. This property makes it safe to use in objects such as **party balloons** and **airships**. To turn helium into a liquid, it must be cooled to an extreme temperature of –269°C (–452°F). Liquid helium is used to make things very cold, including the powerful magnets used to make **maglev trains** float along special tracks. **MRI scanners** also use liquid helium for cooling.